Equation sheet: governing relations of the $CaCO_3$-barrier screen

P0-W3.2 (cp2 fix-up) and P0-W3.3 (cp3), contract v3. Symbolic only; every symbol is in the table overleaf and in `theory/symbols.yaml`; units in brackets.

	R-slurry: aqueous, alkaline, room temperature; casting and drying on native Al_2O_3/AlOOH	R-cell: non-aqueous, fluorine-free electrolyte, collector at anodic potential vs Li^+/Li
Links that apply	C1 adhesion (1), C2 sequestration (2), supersaturation (3), C3 nucleation and Young (4, 5), template action (6), C4 morphology (7), C5 aqueous Pourbaix (8a)	C5 Li-open stability window (8b), C4 insulating-film bound (9). Not defined here: (1)–(7), since there is no hydrated Ca^{2+} reference and no aqueous Ω

1 Adhesion in water (C1, R-slurry)

The polymer never meets a dry oxide: every contact first displaces interfacial water, so the decisive work separates the contact into two water-wetted *surfaces.*

$$W_{\mathrm{adh,wet}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{ow}} + \gamma_{\mathrm{pw}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{op}} \quad [\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}] \tag{1}$$
$$= W_{\mathrm{adh,dry}} + 2\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} - W_{\mathrm{ow}} - W_{\mathrm{pw}}$$
$$W_{\mathrm{adh,dry}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{o}} + \gamma_{\mathrm{p}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{op}} \quad [\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}]$$
$$W_{\mathrm{adh,wet}} = \Delta F_{\mathrm{PMF}}/A_{\mathrm{c}} \quad [\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}] \tag{2}$$

Anchored against water iff $W_{\mathrm{adh,wet}} > 0$; $W_{\mathrm{ow}}, W_{\mathrm{pw}}$ are the dry works of the oxide and polymer with water.

2 Sequestration (C2, R-slurry)

The template raises local Ca^{2+} only if it holds Ca^{2+} more strongly than water does; the cycle starts from hydrated Ca^{2+} at the regime activity.

Cycle: Ca^{2+}(aq, bulk, $a_{Ca^{2+}}$) $\rightarrow$ Ca^{2+}(binding layer). Solution side: molal standard state at the regime ionic strength; layer side: site-volume standard state, $\Delta G_{\mathrm{site}} = -RT\ln\big[V_{\mathrm{site}}^{-1}\int_{\mathrm{site}} \mathrm{e}^{-w(\mathbf{r})/k_{\mathrm{B}}T}\mathrm{d}^3r\big]$, with w the per-ion PMF ($w \rightarrow 0$ in bulk). With one coordinating group that must be deprotonated:

$$\Delta G_{\mathrm{seq}} = \Delta G_{\mathrm{site}} + RT\ln\big(1 + 10^{\,\mathrm{p}K_{\mathrm{a}} - \mathrm{pH}}\big) \quad [\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}] \tag{3}$$

$$\mathcal{E} \equiv \frac{c_{\mathrm{local}}}{c_{\mathrm{bulk}}} = \exp\Big(-\frac{\Delta G_{\mathrm{seq}}}{RT}\Big) \quad [1] \tag{4}$$

Valid for dilute Ca^{2+} with unsaturated sites ($\mathcal{E}c_{\mathrm{bulk}} \ll c_{\mathrm{max}}$). $\mathcal{E}$ is a *concentration* ratio: at equilibrium the Ca^{2+} activity in the layer equals the bulk one, and the enrichment sits in a local activity coefficient. Langmuir closure, with x the occupancy odds:

$$c_{\mathrm{local}} = \frac{\mathcal{E}c_{\mathrm{bulk}}}{1+x} = c_{\mathrm{max}}\Theta, \quad x = \frac{\mathcal{E}c_{\mathrm{bulk}}}{c_{\mathrm{max}}}, \quad \Theta = \frac{x}{1+x} \tag{5}$$
$$c_{\mathrm{max}} = \Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}/\delta_{\mathrm{s}} \ [\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}], \qquad \Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca}} = \Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}\Theta - \delta_{\mathrm{s}}c_{\mathrm{bulk}} \ [\mathrm{mol\,m^{-2}}]$$

Gibbs adsorption: binding lowers the template–liquid energy, $\mathrm{d}\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} = -\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca}}\,\mathrm{d}\mu_{\mathrm{Ca}}$, integrated from zero to the regime activity:

$$\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{sl}}^{(0)} + \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}} \quad [\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}] \tag{6}$$
$$\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}} = -RT\big(\Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}\ln(1+x) - \delta_{\mathrm{s}}c_{\mathrm{bulk}}\big)$$
$$\partial\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}}/\partial\Delta G_{\mathrm{seq}} = \Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}\Theta > 0$$

$\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}} \equiv 0$ if γ_{sl} is computed at the regime activities. **Admissibility (D27):** $\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{sl}}^{(0)} + \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}} \geq 0$ at every state (else the film grows its interface); prior restricted to it, refused draws counted, retained mass reported. Largest lowering at any dose $RT\Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}(\ln\mathcal{E} - 1 + 1/\mathcal{E}) < -\Gamma_{\mathrm{s}}\Delta G_{\mathrm{seq}}$; favourable $f \leq \frac{1}{2} \iff \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}} \leq \gamma_{\mathrm{sl}}$. γ_{sn} is likewise grand-canonical: a Ca^{2+} excess at the contact (ion-bridged carboxylate–Ca–calcite) is inside it, so

$$\partial\gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}/\partial\mu_{\mathrm{Ca}} = -\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sn}}, \qquad \partial(\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}})/\partial\mu_{\mathrm{Ca}} = -(\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sl}} - \Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sn}}) \tag{7}$$

with $\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sl}} = \Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca}}$. Rule for supplied inputs: γ_{sn} comes from contact data at the regime state; ΔG_{seq} is never added to it (no claim that $\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sn}} = 0$).

3 Supersaturation (one definition)

Crystallisation is driven by the excess chemical potential of the dissolved ion pair over the solid of the registered framing (ACC or calcite).

$$\Omega = \frac{\mathrm{IAP}}{K_{\mathrm{sp}}} = \frac{a_{\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}}\,a_{\mathrm{CO_3^{2-}}}}{K_{\mathrm{sp}}}, \qquad \Delta\mu = k_{\mathrm{B}}T\ln\Omega \quad [\mathrm{J}] \tag{8}$$

per $CaCO_3$ formula unit (V_{m} also per formula unit); nucleation requires $\Omega > 1$. **At the template $\Omega = \Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}}$.** At equilibrium $\tilde{\mu}_{\mathrm{Ca}}$ and $\tilde{\mu}_{\mathrm{CO_3}}$ are uniform; a mean potential ψ gives factors $\mathrm{e}^{\mp 2e\psi/k_{\mathrm{B}}T}$ that cancel in the neutral solid, and specific binding lowers the local standard potential by exactly what it raises the concentration. Neither changes $\Delta\mu$:

$$\Delta\mu = \tilde{\mu}_{\mathrm{Ca}} + \tilde{\mu}_{\mathrm{CO_3}} - \mu_{\mathrm{CaCO_3}} = k_{\mathrm{B}}T\ln\Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}} \quad [\mathrm{J}] \tag{9}$$

Activities from speciation (pH, C_{T}, $\mathrm{Ca_T}$, I; pairs $CaCO_3^0$, $CaHCO_3^+$, $CaOH^+$; Davies, $I \leq I_{\mathrm{val}}$):

$$a_{\mathrm{CO_3^{2-}}} = \frac{2m_{C_{\mathrm{T}}}D_{\mathrm{c}}}{B + \sqrt{B^2 + 4A_{\mathrm{c}}P_{\mathrm{c}}m_{C_{\mathrm{T}}}D_{\mathrm{c}}}}, \quad a_{\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}} = \frac{m_{\mathrm{Ca_T}}}{D_{\mathrm{c}} + P_{\mathrm{c}}a_{\mathrm{CO_3^{2-}}}} \tag{10}$$

$B = A_{\mathrm{c}}D_{\mathrm{c}} + P_{\mathrm{c}}(m_{\mathrm{Ca_T}} - m_{C_{\mathrm{T}}})$; no Ca or no pairs gives $a_{\mathrm{CO_3^{2-}}} = m_{C_{\mathrm{T}}}/A_{\mathrm{c}}$; $I \rightarrow 0$ gives ideal activities. c_{bulk} is the free Ca^{2+}. The local-ideal form $\Omega_{\mathrm{li}} = (c_{\mathrm{local}}/c_{\mathrm{bulk}})\Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}}$, $\Delta\mu_{\mathrm{li}} = \Delta\mu_{\mathrm{bulk}} - \Delta G_{\mathrm{seq}}/N_{\mathrm{A}}$, credits the binding free energy to the driving force; it is kept only as the named double-counting demonstration.

4 Classical nucleation (C3, R-slurry)

A cluster pays surface free energy before its volume gains $\Delta\mu$; the barrier is the top of that trade-off. On a substrate the cluster is a spherical cap with the same curvature.

$$\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^* = \frac{16\pi\,\gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}^3 v_{\mathrm{m}}^2}{3\,\Delta\mu^2}, \quad r^* = \frac{2\gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}v_{\mathrm{m}}}{\Delta\mu}, \quad v_{\mathrm{m}} = \frac{V_{\mathrm{m}}}{N_{\mathrm{A}}} \quad [\mathrm{J};\ \mathrm{m}] \tag{11}$$

$$\Delta G_{\mathrm{het}}^* = f(\theta)\,\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^*, \qquad f(\theta) = \tfrac{1}{4}(2+\cos\theta)(1-\cos\theta)^2 \tag{12}$$

$f(0) = 0$, $f(\pi/2) = \frac{1}{2}$, $f(\pi) = 1$; $f'(\theta) = \frac{3}{4}\sin^3\theta \geq 0$, so $0 \leq \Delta G_{\mathrm{het}}^* \leq \Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^*$ on $[0,\pi]$. $\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^* \rightarrow \infty$ as $\Omega \rightarrow 1^+$, and $\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^* \rightarrow 0$ as $\Omega \rightarrow \infty$.

5 Young, with one sign convention

θ is measured through the nucleus. Forming the contact removes substrate–liquid interface and creates substrate–nucleus interface over the same disc; $\cos\theta$ is that energy gain per unit nucleus–liquid energy.

$$\cos\theta = \frac{\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}}{\gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}}, \qquad \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}^{(0)} + \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} \quad [1;\ \mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}] \tag{13}$$

$\theta = 0$: the nucleus wets the template completely (no barrier); $\theta = \pi$: no wetting (homogeneous barrier). $\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} \equiv \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}^{(0)}$ is the free energy per unit contact area to displace the template-bound water layer; $\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} > 0$ **is a cost** and raises θ, f and $\Delta G_{\mathrm{het}}^*$ ($\partial\cos\theta/\partial\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} = -1/\gamma_{\mathrm{nl}} < 0$). If γ_{sn} is supplied as a full in-water interfacial free energy, $\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} \equiv 0$ and is not added again. $\gamma_{\mathrm{eff}} \equiv \gamma_{\mathrm{nl}} - \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}}$ (deck form) is **not** used: Young and $\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^*$ take the bare γ_{nl}. Reason: γ_{nl} multiplies the cap's free surface, which never touches the template, and $\Delta G_{\mathrm{het}}^* = f\,\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^*$ follows only if the same γ_{nl} sits in Young and in $\Delta G_{\mathrm{hom}}^*$. With γ_{eff} in the denominator, $\partial\cos\theta/\partial\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}} = (\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}^{(0)})/\gamma_{\mathrm{eff}}^2 > 0$ on the wetting side: a cost would lower the barrier.

6 Where the template acts (screen rule)

In the grand potential at the bulk chemical potentials every template–ion interaction sits in the interfacial energies, so the

template acts only through θ; the driving force is the bulk one.

$$\Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{het}} = f\big(\theta[\gamma^{(0)}_{\mathrm{sl}} + \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}},\, \gamma^{(0)}_{\mathrm{sn}},\, \Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{w}}]\big)\, \frac{16\pi\gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}^{3} v_{\mathrm{m}}^{2}}{3\big(k_{\mathrm{B}}T\ln\Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}}\big)^{2}} \quad (14)$$

Rule: ΔG_{seq} enters once, through $\Delta\gamma_{\mathrm{ads}}$ in γ_{sl}; $\partial\Omega/\partial(\text{template inputs}) = 0$. If γ_{sl} is computed at the regime activities, add nothing. At fixed $\gamma^{(0)}_{\mathrm{sl}}, \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}$, stronger binding *lowers* $\cos\theta$ and raises $\Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{het}}$ (SF2): binding helps only if γ_{sn} falls by more than γ_{sl}, i.e. if $\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sn}} > \Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sl}}$. Lowering γ_{nl} lowers f only if $\gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} > \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}}$ (SF3). Proof: derivation, Section 7.

6a Accessibility of the barrier (C3)

Nuclei must form at the stated areal density within the time the template spends in the slurry and drying.

$$J = J_0 \mathrm{e}^{-\Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{het}}/k_{\mathrm{B}}T}, \qquad N_{\mathrm{nuc}} = J t_{\mathrm{p}} \geq N_{\mathrm{req}} \\ \iff \quad \Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{het}} \leq B_{\mathrm{acc}} = k_{\mathrm{B}}T\ln(J_0 t_{\mathrm{p}}/N_{\mathrm{req}}) \quad (15)$$

$N_{\mathrm{req}} = \ln(1/q_0)/A_{\mathrm{patch}}$ with $q_0 = 1 - p$: Poisson occupancy leaves a fraction $\mathrm{e}^{-N_{\mathrm{nuc}}A_{\mathrm{patch}}} \leq q_0$ of the particle–collector contact patches without a nucleus.

7 Conformality (C4, R-slurry)

A barrier needs a continuous film; whether the mineral spreads or beads is a wetting balance, not a barrier height.

$$S_{\mathrm{spread}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{sl}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{sn}} - \gamma_{\mathrm{nl}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}(\cos\theta - 1) \quad [\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}] \quad (16)$$

$S_{\mathrm{spread}} \geq 0$: no finite θ ($\theta \to 0$, $f \to 0$), layer-by-layer growth. $S_{\mathrm{spread}} < 0$: $\theta > 0$, island growth; a film forms only on coalescence, at cap height $h_{\mathrm{c}} = \tan(\theta/2)/(2\sqrt{N_{\mathrm{s}}})$, and closes at $h_{\mathrm{cl}} = \sqrt{2}h_{\mathrm{c}} \leq d_{\max}$ iff $N_{\mathrm{s}} \geq \tan^{2}(\theta/2)/(2d^{2}_{\max})$ [m; $\mathrm{m^{-2}}$]. A small-θ bound and $S_{\mathrm{spread}} \geq 0$ are one criterion at different strictness ($S_{\mathrm{spread}} = \gamma_{\mathrm{nl}}(\cos\theta - 1)$); coalescence is the independent one. A low f does not imply coverage: $f(\pi/2) = \frac{1}{2}$ is still island growth. h_{c} is geometric; the kinetic critical coalescence thickness of the charter is h_{coal} (not computed in P0).

8 Stability (C5): screens, necessary not sufficient

(a) R-slurry, aqueous Pourbaix, per non-O, non-H atom [$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$]:

$$\Psi_{\phi} = \tfrac{1}{n_{\mathrm{M}}}\big[G_{\phi} - n_{\mathrm{O}}\mu_{\mathrm{H_2O}} - RT\ln 10\,(2n_{\mathrm{O}} - n_{\mathrm{H}})\,\mathrm{pH} \\ - (2n_{\mathrm{O}} - n_{\mathrm{H}} + Q)FE_{\mathrm{SHE}}\big] \quad (17)$$

$\Delta G_{\mathrm{pbx}} = \Psi_{\phi} - \Psi_{\mathrm{hull}} \geq 0$; zero means stable at (pH, E_{SHE}). **Dissolution is decided by** $\Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}} \geq 1$ with the calcite K_{sp}, the Ω_{bulk} of C3: at fixed C(IV), $\Delta G_{\mathrm{pbx}}|_{\mathrm{diss}} = (RT/n_{\mathrm{M}})\ln(1/\Omega_{\mathrm{bulk}})$, so a hull tolerance hides undersaturation. The hull (dissolved Ca removed) decides only competing solids; the oxide is a baseline.

(b) R-cell, Li open, E_{Li} vs $\mathrm{Li^{+}/Li}$ [$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$; V]:

$$\mu_{\mathrm{Li}} = \mu^{\circ}_{\mathrm{Li}} - FE_{\mathrm{Li}}, \qquad \Phi_{\phi} = G_{\phi} - n_{\mathrm{Li}}\mu_{\mathrm{Li}} \quad (18)$$

Window $[E_{\mathrm{red}}, E_{\mathrm{ox}}]$: the E_{Li} over which ϕ lies on the Li-open hull.

9 Insulating film (C4 limitation, R-cell)

The mineral is an electronic insulator, so conformality cannot be bought with thickness; the film must still pass the collector current.

$$R_A = \rho_{\mathrm{e}} d \leq R_{A,\max} \;\Rightarrow\; d \leq R_{A,\max}/\rho_{\mathrm{e}} \quad [\Omega\,\mathrm{m^{2}};\ \mathrm{m}] \quad (19)$$

$$j = j_0 \mathrm{e}^{-2\kappa d}, \quad \kappa = \frac{\sqrt{2m_{\mathrm{e}}\phi_{\mathrm{B}}}}{\hbar} \;\Rightarrow\; d \leq \frac{\ln(j_0/j_{\mathrm{req}})}{2\kappa} \quad [\mathrm{m}] \quad (20)$$

Symbols generated from `theory/symbols.yaml`; Reg.: S = R-slurry, C = R-cell; – = dimensionless

Symbol	Meaning	SI unit	Reg.
Exact SI constants (kept symbolic)			
k_{B}	Boltzmann constant	$\mathrm{J\,K^{-1}}$	S,C
N_{A}	Avogadro constant	$\mathrm{mol^{-1}}$	S,C
R	molar gas constant	$\mathrm{J\,K^{-1}\,mol^{-1}}$	S,C
F	Faraday constant	$\mathrm{C\,mol^{-1}}$	S,C
e	elementary charge	C	S,C
$\hbar$	reduced Planck constant	J s	C
m_{e}	electron mass	kg	C
State variables			
T	absolute temperature of the regime	K	S,C
pH	pH (molal scale)	–	S
E_{SHE}	collector potential vs SHE	V	S
E_{Li}	collector potential vs $\mathrm{Li^+/Li}$	V	C
Adhesion in water (C1)			
γ_{ow}	oxide-water interfacial free energy	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{pw}	polymer-water interfacial free energy	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{op}	oxide-polymer interfacial free energy in contact	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{o}	oxide surface free energy against vacuum	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{p}	polymer surface free energy against vacuum	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{w}	water surface free energy against its vapour	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
γ_{n}	nucleus surface free energy against vacuum (dry)	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$W_{\mathrm{adh,wet}}$	work of adhesion in water (Dupre)	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$W_{\mathrm{adh,dry}}$	work of adhesion against vacuum (comparator)	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
ΔF_{PMF}	PMF free energy, separated minus bound	J	S
A_{c}	fragment contact area	$\mathrm{m^2}$	S
Sequestration (C2)			
ΔG_{seq}	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ transfer free energy, bulk to binding layer	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
ΔG_{site}	transfer free energy to the deprotonated site	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
$\mathrm{p}K_{\mathrm{a}}$	pKa of the coordinating group	–	S
$\mathrm{p}K_{\mathrm{a2}}$	second pKa of a two-proton group	–	S
K_{CaL}	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ complexation constant in solution	–	S
c°	standard concentration of a solution constant	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
$\mathcal{E}$	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ enrichment factor (dilute limit)	–	S
c_{bulk}	bulk $\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ concentration	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
c_{local}	mean $\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ concentration in the layer	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
c_{max}	saturation concentration of the layer	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
Γ_{s}	areal binding-site density	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-2}}$	S
δ_{s}	binding-layer thickness	m	S
V_{site}	volume per binding site	$\mathrm{m^3}$	S
a_{site}	footprint area of one binding site	$\mathrm{m^2}$	S
ρ_{L}	volume density of coordinating groups	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
ρ_{PDA}	template mass density	$\mathrm{kg\,m^{-3}}$	S
M_{u}	least mass per group	$\mathrm{kg\,mol^{-1}}$	S
d_{layer}	template layer thickness	m	S
r_{Ca}	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ ionic radius	m	S
x	Langmuir binding variable	–	S
Θ	fraction of sites occupied by $\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$	–	S
Γ_{Ca}	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ surface excess (Gibbs)	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-2}}$	S
$\Gamma_{\mathrm{Ca,sn}}$	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ excess at the template-nucleus contact	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-2}}$	S
Carbonate speciation (activities)			
m°	standard molality	$\mathrm{mol\,kg^{-1}}$	S
ρ_{w}	density of water	$\mathrm{kg\,m^{-3}}$	S
I	ionic strength (molal)	$\mathrm{mol\,kg^{-1}}$	S
C_{T}	dissolved inorganic carbon	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
$\mathrm{Ca_T}$	total dissolved calcium	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
$\mathrm{p}K_1$	pK1 of carbonic acid	–	S
$\mathrm{p}K_2$	pK2 of carbonic acid	–	S
$K_{\mathrm{CaCO_3^0}}$	formation constant of $\mathrm{CaCO_3(aq)}$	–	S
$K_{\mathrm{CaHCO_3^+}}$	formation constant of CaHCO3+	–	S
${}^{*}K_{\mathrm{CaOH^+}}$	hydrolysis constant of CaOH+	–	S
A_{DH}	Debye-Hueckel constant	–	S
b_{D}	Davies linear coefficient	–	S
I_{val}	upper validity bound of the activity model	$\mathrm{mol\,kg^{-1}}$	S
$\gamma_{\pm 1}$	activity coefficient, charge one	–	S
$\gamma_{\pm 2}$	activity coefficient, charge two	–	S
$m_{C_{\mathrm{T}}}$	dissolved inorganic carbon, molal	–	S
$m_{\mathrm{Ca_T}}$	total calcium, molal	–	S
A_{c}	carbonate speciation factor	–	S
P_{c}	ion-pair factor	–	S
D_{c}	free-calcium factor	–	S
P_{T}	total dissolved phosphate	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-3}}$	S
$\mathrm{p}K_1^{\mathrm{P}}$	pK1 of phosphoric acid	–	S
$\mathrm{p}K_2^{\mathrm{P}}$	pK2 of phosphoric acid	–	S
$\mathrm{p}K_3^{\mathrm{P}}$	pK3 of phosphoric acid	–	S
$\mathrm{p}K_{\mathrm{w}}$	pK of water	–	S
$K_{\mathrm{CaHPO_4^0}}$	formation constant of CaHPO4(aq)	–	S
$K_{\mathrm{CaH_2PO_4^+}}$	formation constant of CaH2PO4+	–	S
$K_{\mathrm{CaPO_4^-}}$	formation constant of CaPO4-	–	S
$\gamma_{\pm 3}$	activity coefficient, charge three	–	S
$m_{P_{\mathrm{T}}}$	total phosphate, molal	–	S
A_{p}	phosphate speciation factor	–	S
P_{p}	phosphate ion-pair factor	–	S
Supersaturation			
$a_{\mathrm{PO_4^{3-}}}$	free phosphate activity	–	S
$a_{\mathrm{HPO_4^{2-}}}$	free hydrogen phosphate activity	–	S
$a_{\mathrm{OH-}}$	hydroxide activity	–	S,C
$a_{\mathrm{Ca2+}}$	bulk $\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ activity	–	S
$a_{\mathrm{CO_3^{2-}}}$	bulk carbonate activity	–	S
K_{sp}	solubility product of the registered mineral framing	–	S
a_{w}	water activity of the regime state	–	S
m	structural water per formula unit (hydrated		S

Symbol	Meaning	SI unit	Reg.
$\Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{hom}}$	homogeneous nucleation barrier per nucleus	J	S
$\Delta G^{*}_{\mathrm{het}}$	heterogeneous barrier on the template	J	S
Accessibility of the barrier (C3)			
J_0	heterogeneous nucleation prefactor per area	$\mathrm{m^{-2}\,s^{-1}}$	S
t_{p}	time available for nucleation	s	S
N_{req}	required areal density of nuclei	$\mathrm{m^{-2}}$	S
q_0	admissible fraction of empty contact patches	–	S
A_{patch}	particle-collector contact patch	$\mathrm{m^2}$	S
d_{p}	particle diameter	m	S
a_{asp}	asperity contact area	$\mathrm{m^2}$	S
B_{acc}	largest accessible barrier	J	S
N_{nuc}	expected areal density of nuclei	$\mathrm{m^{-2}}$	S
Conformality (C4)			
S_{spread}	spreading coefficient	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
N_{s}	island density at coalescence	$\mathrm{m^{-2}}$	S
h_{c}	geometric coalescence thickness	m	S
h_{cl}	geometric closure thickness	m	S
h_{coal}	kinetic critical coalescence thickness (charter C4 (c))	m	S
Stability (C5)			
G_{ϕ}	molar Gibbs energy of species phi	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
$\mu_{\mathrm{H_2O}}$	chemical potential of water	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
n_{O}	number of O atoms per formula unit	–	S
n_{H}	number of H atoms per formula unit	–	S
n_{M}	number of non-O, non-H atoms	–	S
Q	species charge in units of e	–	S
Ψ_{ϕ}	Pourbaix potential per metal atom	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
Ψ_{hull}	lower envelope of Psi (the hull)	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
ΔG_{pbx}	energy above the aqueous Pourbaix hull	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S
n_{Li}	number of Li atoms per formula unit	–	C
$\mu^{\circ}_{\mathrm{Li}}$	Li chemical potential in Li metal	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
μ_{Li}	Li chemical potential at the electrode potential	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
Φ_{ϕ}	Li-open grand potential	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
ΔG_{r}	reaction free energy against Li metal	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
Δn	Li released by the reaction	–	C
$\Delta\Phi$	grand-potential change of the reaction	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
E^{*}	potential limit set by one reaction	V	C
E_{red}	lower limit of the stability window	V	C
E_{ox}	upper limit of the stability window	V	C
E_{c}	charge cutoff	V	C
$\Delta G^{\mathrm{ss}}_{\mathrm{r}}$	reaction free energy, solid-salt sink	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
$\Delta G^{\mathrm{aq}}_{\mathrm{r}}$	reaction free energy, aqueous sink	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
$\Delta G^{\mathrm{rel}}_{\mathrm{tr}}$	relative transfer free energy, water to the cell solvent	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
E_{ub}	K1 onset, solid-salt sink (upper end)	V	C
E_{lb}	K1 onset, aqueous sink (lower end)	V	C
E_{S}	K1 onset in the cell solvent	V	C
$E^{\mathrm{g}}_{\mathrm{lb}}$	K1 lower end, amorphous framing	V	C
$E^{\mathrm{g}}_{\mathrm{ub}}$	K1 upper end, amorphous framing	V	C
B_{S}	Born transfer constant	$\mathrm{J\,m\,mol^{-1}}$	C
z_{M}	charge number of the product cation	–	C
r_{M}	Born radius of the product cation	m	C
r_{Li}	Born radius of $\mathrm{Li^+}$	m	C
E_{svc}	measured service limit (tier 2)	V	C
ΔG_{hyd}	single-ion hydration free energy	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	C
Registration constants (theory/thresholds.md)			
m_{svc}	K1 tier-2 margin	V	C
Insulating film (C4, R-cell)			
d	film thickness	m	C
ρ_{e}	film electronic resistivity	$\Omega\,\mathrm{m}$	C
R_A	area-specific film resistance	$\Omega\,\mathrm{m^2}$	C
$R_{A,\mathrm{max}}$	admissible area-specific resistance (input)	$\Omega\,\mathrm{m^2}$	C
ϕ_{B}	tunnelling barrier height	J	C
κ	tunnelling decay constant	$\mathrm{m^{-1}}$	C
j_0	tunnelling prefactor current density	$\mathrm{A\,m^{-2}}$	C
j_{req}	required current density (input)	$\mathrm{A\,m^{-2}}$	C
$d^{\mathrm{tun}}_{\mathrm{max}}$	thickness bound, direct tunnelling	m	C
d_{max}	admissible film thickness	m	C
$d^{\mathrm{ohm}}_{\mathrm{max}}$	thickness bound, ohmic limit	m	C
Route layer of the redirected screen (K1 to K4, routes R1 to R3)			
$\Delta G_{\mathrm{g\to c}}$	glass-to-crystal free energy	$\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$	S,C
k_{hyd}	measured hydrolysis rate constant	$\mathrm{s^{-1}}$	S
τ_k	transfer factor of the hydrolysis rate	–	S
$t_{1/2}$	half-life of the condensed fraction	s	S
t_{wet}	wet residence time	s	S
$a_{\mathrm{w,dry}}$	water activity that ends the wet period	–	S
f_{cond}	condensed fraction at the end of the wet period	–	S
Registration constants (theory/thresholds.md)			
f_{min}	least condensed fraction	–	S
Route layer of the redirected screen (K1 to K4, routes R1 to R3)			
f_{Ca}	$\mathrm{Ca^{2+}}$ enhancement of the hydrolysis rate	–	S
$K^{\mathrm{Al}}_{\mathrm{ox}}$	oxide solubility constant for Al3+	–	S
$a_{\mathrm{Al^{3+}}}$	free Al3+ activity	–	S,C
$a^{\mathrm{tot}}_{\mathrm{PP}}$	chain-unit activity without complexation	–	S
a_{PP}	free chain-unit activity	–	S
β_{AlPP}	Al3+ polyphosphate binding constant	–	S
ν_{Al}	Al per formula unit of the gel	–	S
ν_{PP}	chain units per formula unit of the gel	–	S
$K^{\mathrm{AlPP}}_{\mathrm{sp}}$	solubility product of the Al polyphosphate gel	–	S
Ω_{AlPP}	saturation ratio of the Al polyphosphate gel	–	S
$\gamma^{\mathrm{c}}_{\mathrm{sl}}$	oxide - dilute phase energy	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$\gamma^{\mathrm{c}}_{\mathrm{sn}}$	oxide - coacervate energy	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$\gamma^{\mathrm{c},(0)}_{\mathrm{sl}}$	site-free oxide - dilute contact	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$\gamma^{\mathrm{c},(0)}_{\mathrm{sn}}$	site-free oxide - coacervate contact	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
$\gamma^{\mathrm{c}}_{\mathrm{nl}}$	coacervate - dilute tension	$\mathrm{J\,m^{-2}}$	S
Γ_{P}	polyphosphate site density on the oxide	$\mathrm{mol\,m^{-2}}$	S
K_{P}	Langmuir constant, activity form	–	S

Conventions. Angles in rad; free energies per formula unit (J) or per mole ($\mathrm{J\,mol^{-1}}$) as stated; activities on the molal scale; potentials vs SHE in R-slurry and vs $\mathrm{Li^+/Li}$ in R-cell. Ω is the only supersaturation variable (the charter's S for C3 is Ω). Functions, limits and sign-flip tests: `theory/contract.yaml`.